

step	meaning
identify parameter	choose the non-gain parameter that varies from 0 to $+\infty$
rewrite characteristic equation	convert $B(s) + aA(s) = 0$ into $1 + aA(s)/B(s) = 0$
build equivalent open loop	treat a as the equivalent root-locus gain
reuse root-locus rules	analyze real-axis locus, asymptotes, breakaway, and imaginary-axis crossing